

AI Voice / Calling — Competitor Intelligence Report

Live market research (June 2026). Funding, sentiment, and niche-positioning of every relevant AI voice / receptionist player, built to answer one question: where is there still a defensible wedge — and which niches are already taken. Data is from public web sources (news, G2, Capterra, Trustpilot, Reddit, company sites); funding figures marked "reported/approx" where not from primary filings. Not investment advice.

0. The hard truth (read this first)

The demand is overwhelmingly validated — and so is the competition. **Voice AI is one of the most heavily-funded categories in tech right now, and nearly every obvious vertical already has a well-funded specialist.** Critically: **even the physiotherapy-plus-Jane-App wedge we planned is already occupied** (Rebookly.ai, Kickcall), and **home services already has a \$1B unicorn** (Avoca).

Implication: the winning move is **not** "pick a vertical" — every good one is taken. It is to win on **(1) distribution we already own, (2) geography/accent the US-funded players ignore, and (3) the #1 incumbent weakness: reliability + support.** Details below.

1. The competitive map — who plays where (so we avoid head-to-head)

Segment	Players	Our overlap
Enterprise contact-center AI	Sierra, Decagon, Parloa, PolyAI, Cresta, Ada, Wonderful, Uniphore	None — not our market
Voice infrastructure (build-your-own)	Vapi, Retell, Bland, Synthflow, ElevenLabs, Telnyx	These are our suppliers , not competitors (but could move up-stack)
Healthcare — dental/ medical (broad)	Weave (public), NexHealth (\$1B), Luma Health, Hyro, Artera, Sully.ai, Arini (dental), DentalBase, DeepCura, Vocca, Simbie	High — adjacent to physio
Physiotherapy-specific	Rebookly.ai , Kickcall (both Jane-App-integrated)	DIRECT — our planned wedge is taken
Home services / trades	Avoca (\$1B), Jobber AI Receptionist, ServiceTitan	DIRECT — our "vertical 2" is contested
Restaurants	Slang.ai	None
Auto dealerships	Numa	None
Generic SMB receptionist	Goodcall, Rosie, Smith.ai (hybrid), Echowin, Greetmate, MyAIFrontDesk	Crowded price-race

2. Funding & scale — who has the war chest

Company	Funding / valuation (reported)	Focus	Note
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ElevenLabs	\$11B val · \$500M Series D	Voice models / infra	Could power everyone
Sierra	\$10B val · \$350M raised	Enterprise CX agents	Bret Taylor
Decagon	~ \$4B val · \$250M (Jan '26)	Enterprise CX	—
Parloa	\$3B val · \$350M (Jan '26)	Enterprise CX	Tripled in 8 mo
NexHealth	\$1B val · \$125M Series C	Healthcare scheduling/ EHR	Dental/medical
Avoca	\$1B val · \$125M Series B (Apr '26)	Home services / trades	Purpose-built for contractors
PolyAI	\$750M val · \$86M	Enterprise call center	UK
Vapi	\$500M val	Voice infra	Won Amazon Ring
Bland	~\$115M total (\$40M B + \$16M A + \$50M Jun '26)	Enterprise outbound	"Rejected by 180 investors"
Weave	Public (NYSE: WEAV) · ~\$65M Q1 rev	Healthcare/dental SMB comms	Acquired TrueLark; AI receptionist Q2 '26
Hyro	\$35M Series B ext	Healthcare conversational AI	—
Retell	~\$14M total · \$4.6M seed (YC) · \$15M ARR	Voice infra (our likely supplier)	Lean, fast-growing
Goodcall / Rosie / Echowin / Numa / Slang.ai	Small / SMB	Generic + niche SMB	Price race \$49–399/mo
Rebookly / Kickcall	Small / early	Physio + Jane App	Direct micro-competitors

Takeaway: we cannot out-raise or out-spend this field. Enterprise CX alone has **>\$25B of combined valuation**. We must win on focus, distribution, and execution — not capital.

3. Sentiment & reviews — where the incumbents are weak (our openings)

The complaints are remarkably consistent and point to a real opening:

Player	Rating	Recurring complaints (the openings)
Weave (the giant in our adjacent space)	4.6 G2 (426 reviews)	"Support disappears after onboarding" (the #1, most-repeated complaint) · phone freezes / drops server connection · "a new glitch every week, no actual fix" · confirmations sent to wrong patients · features moved to higher tiers at renewal · Open Dental write-back failures
Smith.ai (hybrid human+AI)	4.3 Trustpilot / 4.7 G2	Unauthorized call transfers inflating bills · budget +20–30% over base for overages · slow/hard-to-reach support
Vapi (infra)	—	Punishes non-engineers; five vendor invoices to manage
Bland (infra)	—	Requires engineers "living inside Pathways"; latency drift
Avoca (home services)	Mostly positive	Hard to find complaints — a well-executed unicorn (a sign trades is <i>well</i> -served already)
General category	—	"Sounds robotic," billing surprises, weak post-sale support recur across the board

*The pattern: **the funded incumbents win the demo and the onboarding, then fail on reliability and post-sale support.**** That is a genuine, repeated, ownable wedge — ***the AI front desk that actually works, and actually answers when you need help.**"*

4. Niche direction — where each is pushing (so we don't collide)

- **Enterprise CX players** (Sierra/Decagon/Parloa/PolyAI) are racing **up-market** to large contact centers — away from SMB. (*Open below them.*)
 - **Weave / NexHealth** own **dental + medical SMB** and are bundling AI into existing comms suites. Weave is broad, not physio-deep, and **weak on reliability/support**.
 - **Avoca** owns **home-services/trades** decisively (purpose-built, \$1B) — *this makes our "construction vertical 2" a hard fight.*
 - **Rebookly / Kickcall** are early and small in **physio + Jane** — they exist, but are not yet entrenched giants.
 - **Generic SMB tools** (Goodcall/Rosie) compete on **price** (\$49–208/mo) — a commoditizing race to the bottom.
 - **Geography**: the entire funded field is **US-English-centric**. Canada-specific and multicultural/accent handling is largely unaddressed at scale.
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5. Where is anything actually open? (white-space analysis)

Given the above, the genuinely defensible wedges are narrow — and they are **not** "another vertical bot":

1. **Distribution-owned entry.** We *own* 7 physio clinics + GC clients + a realtor network. Competitors must **pay** to acquire customers we already have. Our first 50–100 customers cost us ~nothing — a structural CAC advantage no amount of their funding replicates quickly.
 2. **Geography + accent.** Canada-first (PHIPA/Jane-native) + multicultural/accent-tuned (our realtor market). The US unicorns are not optimised for this, and it compounds into a data moat.
 3. **Reliability + support as the product promise.** Directly attack the #1 incumbent failure (Weave's vanishing support, billing surprises). "It works, and a human answers" is a real positioning.
 4. **A non-obvious angle, if the above aren't enough:** be the *layer* others lack (e.g., a best-in-class **speed-to-lead caller** for paid-ad leads, where most incumbents focus on inbound answering), or a multi-vertical "front desk" for the *long tail* of small service businesses the specialists ignore.
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6. Strategic implications for our plan

- **Reset the "pick a vertical" assumption.** Physio+Jane and home-services are contested; differentiation must come from **distribution + geography + reliability**, not vertical choice alone.
 - **Lead with what only we have:** our owned businesses (instant customers + proprietary call data) and our Canada/accent edge.
 - **Position against incumbent weakness:** reliability, transparent billing, and real support — the things Weave and Smith.ai are hammered for.
 - **Re-examine the life-commitment question honestly.** This is a proven but red-hot market. It can absolutely be a strong business (especially with our distribution). Whether it is a *billion-dollar, devote-your-life* bet depends on whether the distribution + geography + reliability wedge proves defensible in customer discovery — which is exactly what the validation plan (interviews, smoke test, pilot) must now test, with eyes open to this competition.
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7. Recommended next research / validation steps

1. **Deep-dive the two direct micro-competitors** (Rebookly, Kickcall): pricing, traction, reviews, gaps — they are the closest read on "is physio+Jane winnable."
2. **Mine 50+ reviews of Weave + Avoca + Smith.ai** for the exact, repeated pains to build positioning against.

3. **Customer-discovery interviews** with our own clinic/contractor network: have they been pitched by these players? what would make them switch?
 4. **Smoke test** our differentiated angle (Canada + reliability + owned-distribution) before committing.
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Sources: TechCrunch (Parloa, Vapi), Fortune/Yahoo (Bland), SiliconANGLE (PolyAI), Newcomer, Weave Q1'26 earnings, FierceHealthcare (Hyro), AI Automation Global (Avoca), G2/Capterra/Trustpilot (Weave, Smith.ai), Retell/Bland blogs, Rebookly.ai, Kickcall.ai, Grand View / Market.us (market size). Funding figures are reported/approximate; verify against PitchBook/CB Insights before any decision.